

Time Trends Findings

Presentation 4

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Recommendations

1. Optimize staffing schedules to match call volume and duration trends for seniors, improving efficiency and customer experience
2. Reduce ClosedQueue rates and misrouting through better capacity planning and menu redesign

Dashboard Changes

Expanded call duration calculation

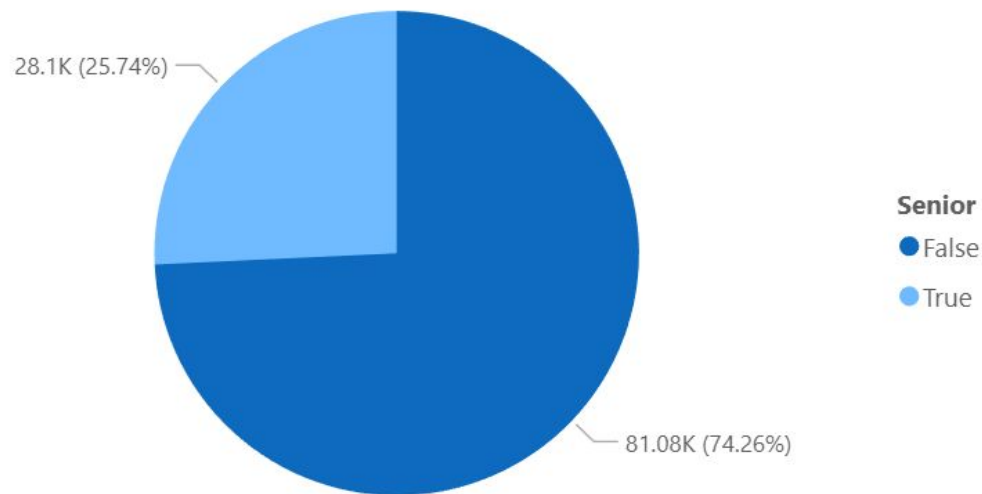
- **Total Call Duration** (Edge Cases Adjusted) - The active length of a call session, measured by pausing and resuming the duration for idle periods between disconnections and callbacks.
- **Menu Time** - Time spent by the user navigating menus, derived by subtracting queue time and agent time from the adjusted call duration.
- **Queue Time** - Time callers spend waiting in queues. Derived using Krish's logic.
- **Agent Time** - Time spent actively connected to a live agent or chat bot. Derived by looking for time periods with consecutive matching values in the Agent Name column.

Addressing Questions

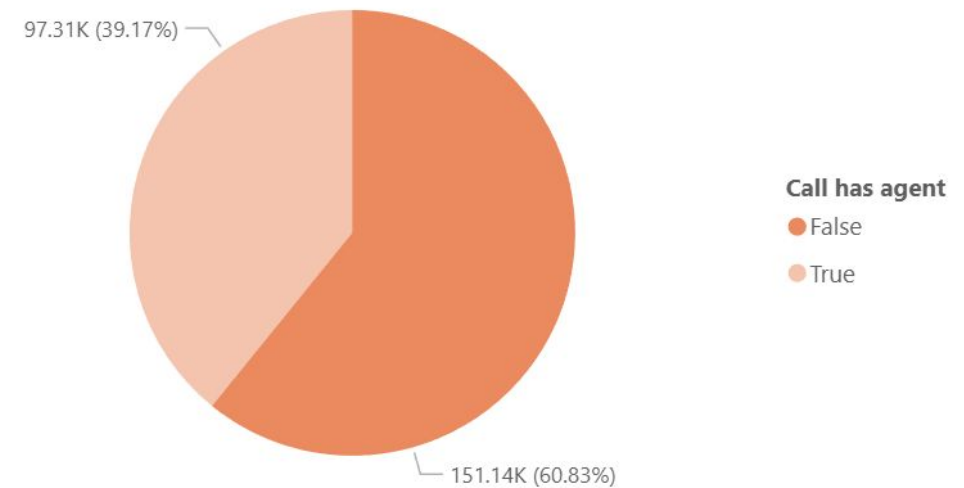
- Filtering for seniors is fixed
- Calculation errors corrected - suburban seniors Friday trend & CallbackRetry trend
- We are unsure about Closed Menu Trend
- Non-cook county seniors trend is likely an outlier - not worth investigating

Most calls do not reach an agent. About a quarter of calls are seniors, and seniors reach an agent even less frequently than non-seniors (~35%).

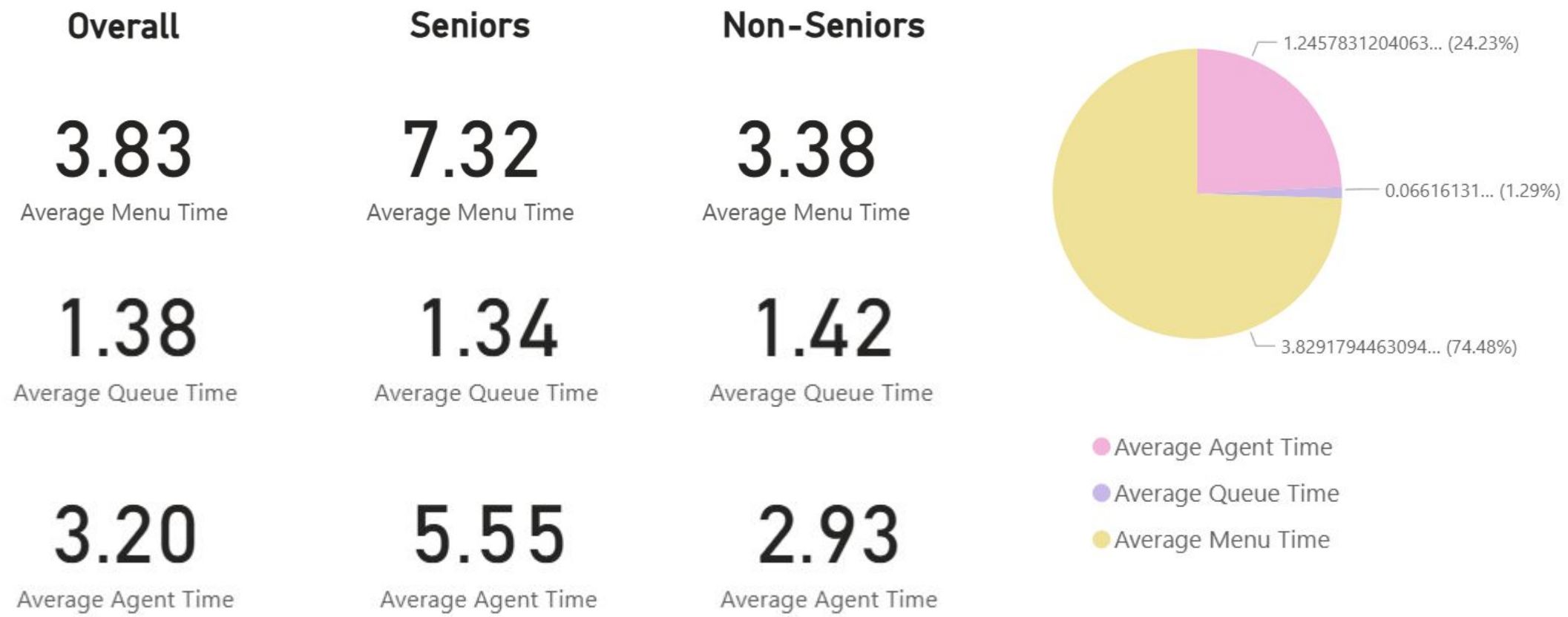
Total Calls: Seniors vs. Non-Seniors



Total Calls: With Agent vs. Without



Calls to the Seniors menu and its submenus show significantly higher average durations and peak earlier in the day, suggesting these interactions are more complex and time-sensitive than other caller groups.



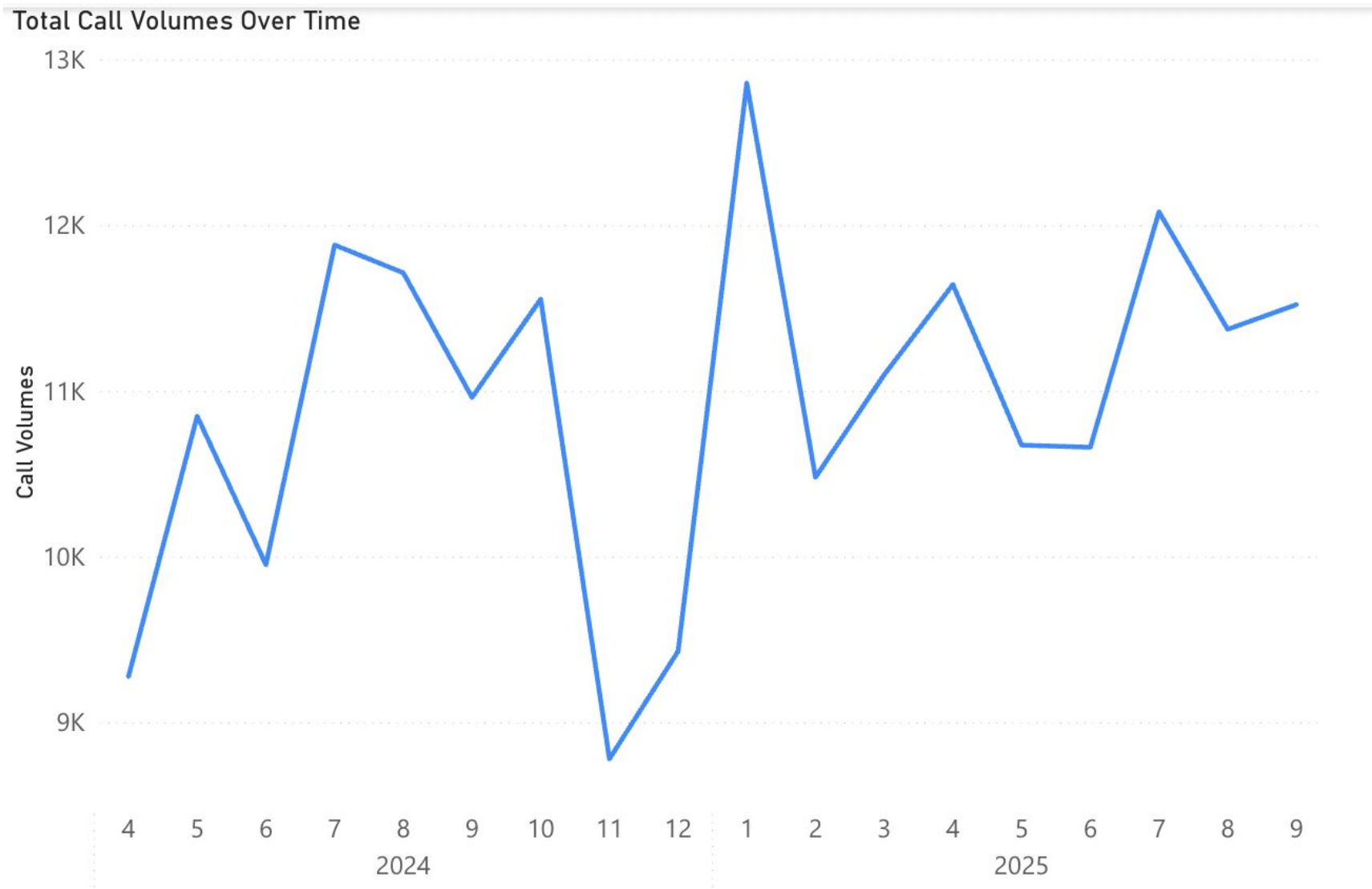
Optimize staffing schedules to align with call behavior patterns and improve response efficiency.

- Increase staffing coverage in the **mornings and early in the week** to match the higher call volume and longer call durations during these peak periods.
- Allocate additional training and support staff to **Seniors** menu topics, and schedule staff trained in these areas to work morning shifts, since these calls tend to be longer and peak earlier in the day, indicating higher complexity and support needs.

Understanding Call Spikes Is Key to Doing More with Less

- Legal aid already operates on thin budgets, and shifting policies and a volatile economy make grants and donations unpredictable
- Call volumes often exceed capacity—many people seeking help can't get through or face long wait times
- Demand likely does not rise evenly between issues; it some menu options spike at specific times—certain days, weeks, or policy moments see surges while others stay quiet
- By understanding and anticipating these spikes, resources can be allocated when and where they're needed most—helping the organization serve more clients without increasing costs

Call volume overall increasing between 2024 and 2025;
trend to continue for foreseeable future



Call Outcomes Across Menus Reveal Agent Availability, Queue Capacity, and User Navigation Issues

[Dashboard Link](#)

Reduce ClosedQueue rates and misrouting through better capacity planning and menu redesign

- **Increase capacity during predictable seasonal peaks for menus where ClosedQueue consistently tracks seasonal trends (Benefits, Employment, Housing, Seniors)**
 - Across these lines, 40–60% of callers are blocked, and the ClosedQueue rate rises and falls in lockstep with overall call volume over time. This indicates a structural capacity shortfall, not random overload—making it clear that agent staffing or queue hours need to expand during known high-demand periods
- **Redesign routing for menus where long-term trends show rising “Other” volume despite falling total calls (Immigration, HIV, Farmworker)**
 - Time trends show that for these menus, the share of callers passing through without receiving help increases over time, even as total call volume declines. This pattern signals growing confusion or misrouting over time, suggesting the need for IVR pathway redesign, clearer naming, or different placement in the menu
- **Preserve successful operational patterns in menus where positive trends persist (ADAPT, Consumer), but smooth out irregular spikes**
 - ADAPT and Consumer show stable long-term trends in agent pickup (60–75%), and Consumer’s ClosedQueue rate declines steadily over the year, suggesting strong processes. ADAPT, however, shows irregular volatility in ClosedQueue spikes over time, recommending finer-grained forecasting and targeted coverage to minimize sudden service interruptions

Next Steps

- Analyze trends in other menus for the different call duration categories using my hierarchical filter
- Add hierarchical filtering for Senior sub-menu options (i.e. Senior ADAPT, SeniorHousing, etc.) in conjunction with the current submenu types (i.e. Agent-Answered, Voicemail, etc.); add in abandonment tagging to track the number of abandoned calls for each menu type over time